

SAE Aero @ Illinois Constitution

Article I: Name & Mission

Section 1. The name of this organization shall be **SAE Aero @ Illinois**. This organization shall have no other aliases that are not derived from the name **SAE Aero @ Illinois**. A name change constitutes an amendment of the constitution.

Section 2. The mission of **SAE Aero @ Illinois** is to provide students at the University of Illinois at Urbana-Champaign with a collaborative and educational environment to develop real-world engineering skills related to the aerospace sector through hands-on engineering, business, and leadership experiences. The organization aims to bring in a diverse group of students to design, construct, and test large scale remote-controlled and autonomous aircraft to compete in the annual SAE Aero Design competition sponsored by the Society of Automotive Engineers.

Article II: Membership

Section 1. Membership in **SAE Aero @ Illinois** is open to all University of Illinois Urbana-Champaign students in good standing, regardless of race, religion, creed, color, sex, gender identity, sexual orientation, national origin, age, disability, or veteran status, in accordance with university non-discrimination policies unless otherwise exempted by the [Student Engagement's Membership Policy](#).

Section 2. All members are expected to serve as professional ambassadors of **SAE Aero @ Illinois** and to actively engage in the organization's work. Participation includes, but is not limited to, the following activities:

- 1) Attending general and sub-team meetings.
- 2) Contributing to promotional and marketing efforts (e.g., tabling, chalking, providing marketing input).
- 3) Participating in workshops and presentations.

Section 3. Membership Benefits- Members of the organization will have the following benefits within the organization:

- 1) Voting Rights
- 2) Ability to travel with RSO
- 3) Eligibility to run for officer roles

Section 4. To be an active and productive member of **SAE Aero @ Illinois** is crucial to the success of the organization.

- 1) **Grounds for Removal:** Members may be removed for failure to fulfill responsibilities, violations of university policy or law, conduct disruptive to SAE Aero @ Illinois, or exceeding permitted unexcused absences.
- 2) **Initiating Removal Process:** Any active member may submit a written removal request to the President (or Leadership if the President is the subject). The request must state the reasons and provide any supporting evidence.
- 3) **Notice & Hearing:** The member will receive notice and be invited to a hearing before the Executive Board, held within 5–15 business days of notification. The member may present their perspective and respond to concerns.
- 4) **Decision:** The Executive Board will deliberate privately and removal requires a two-thirds (2/3) vote of the full Board. The decision will be communicated in writing within three (3) business days.
- 5) **Appeal:** The member may appeal the Executive Board's decision by providing written notice to the Executive Board within 5 business days of their decision being communicated. The Executive Board must then report their decision and rationale to the general membership. A simple majority vote (50%+1) of the general membership is required to either reverse or uphold the Executive Board's decision.

Section 5. All members have the opportunity to contribute to the organization and bear the responsibility of communicating with board members/team leaders to address any issues.

Article III: Officers

Section 1. The Officers of **SAE Aero @ Illinois** shall be a President, Treasurer, and various technical leads.

Section 2. Any officer besides the President may assume the role of Secretary and/or Membership Director.

Section 3. The duties and responsibilities of the President shall include, but not be limited to:

- 1) Act in the best interests of the organization and its members and be willing to invest in the club's future
- 2) Act to preserve the legacy and relationships of the organization
- 3) Act as the main project manager and ensure that the organization is prepared for the competition and other important events
- 4) Represent the Organization (i.e., Participate in Quad Day, RSO Fairs and other events to represent the organization)
- 5) Holds veto power on engineering and club decisions
- 6) Uphold and keep abreast on the Policies & Procedures of SAE Aero @ Illinois
- 7) Mediate internal disputes between members of the organization, or when necessary, disputes between members of the organization and members of external organizations.
- 8) Perform such other duties as ordinarily pertaining to this organization

Section 4. The duties and responsibilities of the Treasurer shall include, but not be limited to:

- 1) Keep an accurate budget for SAE Aero @ Illinois
- 2) Serve as the primary signatory on financial accounts
- 3) Collects Organization dues
- 4) Pays Organization bills
- 5) Maintains a financial history of the organization
- 6) Perform such other duties as ordinarily pertaining to this organization

Section 5. The structure of technical leadership in **SAE Aero @ Illinois** will be clearly defined by the executive board and stated in the by-laws. Technical leadership may have positions including but not limited to:

- 1) Chief engineers/overall sub team leads
- 2) Sub-system leads (e.g. fuselage lead)
- 3) Sub-leads as appointed by technical leadership and/or leadership team.

Section 6. The duties and responsibilities of technical leads shall include, but not be limited to:

- 1) Demonstration of technical ability and/or ability to learn required technical knowledge and skills for the position
- 2) Willingness to teach technical skills and concepts to members
- 3) Attempt to mediate internal disputes between sub team members
- 4) Report to higher leadership on status of projects responsibilities
- 5) Perform such other duties as ordinarily pertaining to this organization

Section 7. Additional positions may be appointed as seen fit by the leadership team.

Section 8. If a vacancy occurs in the office of the President, vacancies position shall be filled by current leadership determined by current officers.

Section 9. Faculty and staff shall not hold an officer position or be eligible to vote.

Article IV: Elections

Section 1. Leadership for the following year shall be determined in April or following participation in the SAE Aero Design competition.

Section 2. Officers must meet the following criteria:

- 1) Have been an active member in good standing with the organization for at least one academic year and be a University of Illinois at Urbana-Champaign student during that time.
- 2) Be a student during their expected term as an officer and be willing to uphold the organization's mission and values.

- 3) Willing to perform all expected duties of the position

Section 3. Members may apply for leadership positions for the next academic year in April. All leadership candidates shall be interviewed by the President, Vice-President, and any other necessary parties.

Section 4. Officers shall be elected to serve one academic year or until their successors are elected. Their term shall begin and end in May or when deemed necessary by current leadership.

Article V: Meetings

Section 1. The organization will hold regularly scheduled meetings as determined by the President. The types of meetings consist of the following:

- 1) Executive/Leadership Meetings - Regular meetings held during the school year for executives and leaders
- 2) General Meetings - Weekly meetings held during the school year for all members
- 3) Sub Team Meeting – Regular meetings held to discuss technical progress
- 4) Work Sessions – Regular meetings held to contribute to progress on projects
- 5) Special Meetings – Extra meetings may be called into session by the President or Vice-President

Section 2. A quorum shall consist of **at least 50% +1** of the membership. For voting to be official, 90% of leadership must be present.

Section 3. Business meetings require the presence of at least 2/3 of leadership.

Article VI: Advisor

Section 1. The organization's Faculty Advisor shall be a faculty or staff member at the University of Illinois at Urbana-Champaign who assists and guides the organization with achieving the purpose specified in Article I.

Section 2. The responsibilities of the advisor shall be to:

- 1) Maintain an awareness of the activities and programs sponsored by the Organization.
- 2) Assist officers and members in interacting with the University of Illinois Urbana-Champaign
- 3) Attend regular meetings, executive board meetings as often as schedule allows.
- 4) Explain and clarify campus policy and procedures that apply to the organization and inform organization members and officers of those factors that constitute unacceptable behavior on the part of the club members, and the possible consequence of said behaviors.

Section 3. Advisors employed by the University of Illinois may not hold any decision-making power or voting rights for the organization as stated in Article III, Section 10.

Section 4. Faculty advisors will need to abide by the appropriate rules in the SAE Aero Design competition and may need to accompany the team to the competition.

Article VII: University Compliance

SAE Aero @ Illinois shall comply with all applicable University of Illinois Urbana-Champaign policies, including but not limited to:

- 1) Campus Administrative Manual (CAM) policies applicable to RSOs.**
- 2) Student Code and policies enforced by the Office of Student Conflict Resolution.**
- 3) Student Engagement policies and processes.**
- 4) Federal, state, and local laws.**
 - a. Title IX Compliance:** SAE Aero @ Illinois will comply with Title IX mandates regarding membership selection ensuring that discrimination does not occur.
 - b. Clery Act Compliance:** SAE Aero @ Illinois will comply with the Clery Act and report all crimes that are witnessed, on or off campus, to the University of Illinois Police Department.
 - c. Anti-Hazing Statement:** SAE Aero @ Illinois understands that the University defines Hazing as an act that endangers the mental or physical health or safety of any person OR that defaces, destroys, or removes public or private property, for the purpose of initiation into, admission into, affiliation with, or continued membership in, any group or organization. SAE Aero @ Illinois will not participate in, sponsor, or condone any acts of hazing.
 - d. Foreign Influence Compliance:** SAE Aero @ Illinois will comply with all local, state, and federal laws regarding foreign influence via financial or general support.

SAE Aero @ Illinois understands it is a separate legal entity from the University and is responsible for its own actions. As such, SAE Aero @ Illinois cannot claim the University's Tax Exempt status or utilize the name of the University in such a way that confuses vendors into providing goods/services tax exempt.

Article VIII: By-laws

Section 1. All members and officers of **SAE Aero @ Illinois** are expected to comply with the organization By-laws which will contain additional information on various practices within the organization.

Article IX: Amendments

Section 1. Amendments may be proposed by any active member of **SAE Aero @ Illinois**.

Section 2. Any proposed amendments will be discussed and voted upon at a meeting following the introduction of said amendments. Voting will take place no longer than 14 days after the proposal.

Section 3. Proposed amendments must be approved by a 2/3 supermajority vote of active members in addition to a 2/3 supermajority vote by the leadership team.